EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

WELCOME

Welcome to Rumsan!

To our Rumsan Team Members,

We're thrilled to have you on board as part of our organization and this exciting journey. Your involvement and contributions will play a vital role in driving our growth and ongoing success.

Thank you for being part of our team—let's achieve great things together!

Welcome aboard!

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Rumee Singh

CEO & Co-Founder, Rumsan Associates

INTRODUCTION

- This Employee Handbook (Handbook) provides an overview of Rumsan's policies, benefits, and general terms of employment. It serves as a guide to help you understand the key aspects of our employment practices and other relevant information.
- Please note that this Handbook is not intended to cover all matters in exhaustive detail. Policies and benefits outlined here may evolve over time in response to changing circumstances, just as past changes have shaped them.
- In the event of any discrepancies between this Handbook and the official terms of applicable benefit plans (e.g., insurance policies), the official plan or policy documents will take precedence.
- For any queries and suggestions, reach out to anusha.thapa@rumsan.com

1. EMPLOYMENT

1.1. Employment Classifications

1.2.1 Regular Employee –

A Regular Employee at Rumsan can be categorized as either full-time or part-time, based on their weekly work schedule:

- Full-Time Employee: Regularly scheduled to work 40 or more hours per week. Full-time employees are eligible for company benefits, provided they meet the specific eligibility requirements for each benefit.
- Part-Time Employee: Regularly scheduled to work less than 40 hours per week. Part-time employees are not automatically entitled to benefits; eligibility will depend on the terms and conditions outlined in their employment agreement.

1.2.3 Contractor -

A Contractor is an individual or company engaged with Rumsan under a specific contractual agreement. Contractors' engagement may be terminated by either party at any time. Contractors may or may not receive company benefits, as outlined in their contractual terms.

1.2.4 Intern -

Internships at Rumsan are designed for individuals seeking professional experience for a fixed period, typically three months. Interns may work in either full-time or part-time capacities:

- Full-Time Intern: Works 40 or more hours per week.
- Part-Time Intern: Works 20 or more hours per week, typically in the first or second half of the day.

Internships are conducted on an "at-will" basis, meaning the relationship can be terminated by either the intern or Rumsan at any time. Eligibility for company compensation/stipend and benefits is not guaranteed and will depend on the specific terms outlined in the internship agreement.

1.2.5 Volunteers –

Volunteers at Rumsan contribute their time and skills without the requirement of a formal contractual agreement. Volunteering is conducted on a voluntary, at-will basis, meaning either the volunteer or Rumsan can end the arrangement at any time.

Volunteers are not considered employees and, as such, are not entitled to compensation or company benefits. Their contributions are greatly valued, and Rumsan is committed to providing a supportive and enriching experience for all volunteers.

1.2 Hours of Work

At Rumsan, we depend on all employees to be punctual and perform their duties responsibly. Here's what you need to know about working hours:

- Standard Hours: Our core business hours are 8 hours daily, Monday through Friday - 10:00 AM - 6:00 PM
- Work Week: The standard work week starts on Monday and ends on Friday.
- Full-Time Schedule: Full-time employees are expected to work 40 hours per week.
- Flexible Hours: If you need to adjust your work schedule, please get approval from your manager in advance.

1.3 Flexible Work Schedules

- It is the policy of Rumsan to offer a range of flexible working options, which are designed to link together business requirements, employee needs, technology, and the workplace to provide a working environment that helps to bring out the best in our employees in the office, at home or on the move. If you desire to temporarily or permanently work a non standard schedule, this can be negotiated with your supervisor.

1.4 Time Recording

- You are to report your time worked on the 15th and 30/31st of each month (bi-monthly) to your supervisor. Timesheets should include hours worked, accounting for all direct and indirect work, plus any vacation time, sick leave, holidays, other paid leave, and leave without pay.

- Timesheet formats and procedures can be negotiated with your supervisor.

1.5 Payroll Schedule

- Employees are paid according to the charge hour of daily-task in Meister task.
- Rumsan operates on a monthly payroll schedule. Pay is made in arrears. Payroll will be paid by the 7th of each month.

- Any errors in your pay, vacation, sick, or personal leave balances should be reported to your manager as soon as possible. Whether an error causes underpayment or overpayment, you are expected to advise your manager to ensure the error is rectified as promptly as possible.

1.6 Deduction

- Rumsan is required by the Government of Nepal to deduct income taxes, workers' compensation insurance, and the provident fund from your paycheck where applicable. You can tentatively calculate income tax - https://merojob.com/tax-calculator/

2. ON-THE-JOB POLICIES

2.1. Open Door Policy

2.1.1. Equal Employment Opportunity Policy

- Rumsan provides equal opportunity for all qualified persons. Employment is based upon personal capabilities and qualifications without discrimination based on race, color, religion, sex, age, natural origin, disability, or any other protected characteristic as established by law.
- Employees with questions or concerns about any type of discrimination in the workplace are encouraged to bring these issues to the attention of their manager. Employees can raise concerns and make reports without fear of reprisal.
- Complaints will be handled confidentially to the extent possible.

- Anyone found to be engaging in any type of unlawful discrimination will be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

2.1.2 Non-Solicitation of Customers, Customer Prospects, and Vendors

- You agree that during the term of your employment with the Company and for twelve (12) months after the termination thereof, regardless of the reason for the employment termination, you will not, directly or indirectly, solicit or attempt to solicit any business from any of the Company's customers, customer prospects, or vendors with whom you had contact.

2.1.3 Non-Solicitation of Employees

- You agree that during the term of your employment with the Company and for twelve (12) months after the termination thereof, regardless of the reason for the employment termination, you will not, directly or indirectly, on your behalf or on behalf of or in conjunction with any person or legal entity, recruit, solicit, or induce, or attempt to recruit, solicit, or induce, any non-clerical employee of the Company with whom you had personal contact or supervised while performing your job duties, to terminate their employment relationship with the Company.

2.1.4 Confidential Nature of Work

- Any employee who discloses confidential business information except through normal channels and with appropriate authorization will be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment, and possible legal action, even if he or she does not benefit from the disclosed information.

2.1.5 Company Owned Equipment

- The Company provides any supplies, equipment, and materials necessary for you to perform your job. Equipment includes but is not limited to such items as telephones, postage, facsimile and copier machines, computers, and software. These items are to be used solely for the Company's purposes.
- The Loss, damages, or theft of Company property should be reported at once. Violation of this policy will result in disciplinary action, and reimbursement, up to and including termination of employment.
- Upon termination of employment, the employee must return all Company property, equipment, work product, and documents in his or her possession or control.

2.1.6 Password and

2.1.6 Internet and Social Media Policy

- Employees representing Rumsan Company on social media, whether officially or unofficially, must maintain professionalism and integrity.
- Content shared on behalf of the company must be accurate, truthful, and respectful of confidentiality and proprietary information.
- Employees are not permitted to engage in behavior that could harm the company's reputation or interests.

Disciplinary Consequences:

- Violation of this policy may result in disciplinary action, including but not limited to verbal warnings, written warnings, suspension, or termination of employment, depending on the severity of the situation.
- Serious violations such as breaches of confidentiality, defamation, harassment, or other misconduct will be subject to immediate investigation and appropriate action.

2.1.7 Policy Attendance and Punctuality

- Attendance is extremely important to the Company. We expect employees to strive for perfect attendance and to arrive at work on time. In instances where you are unable to arrive at work on time, you must notify your immediate supervisor or the administration.
- You must submit documentation for absences due to illness of three (2) days or more. Generally, you must provide a document from your doctor or other recognized health care provider that would justify your absence. Likewise, you will need to provide documentation justifying your return to work.
- Excessive absences, or lateness and excessive patterns of absences or lateness may lead to disciplinary action, up to and including termination. If you are absent from work for three (3) consecutive days without notice, the company will consider that you have voluntarily resigned from your position.

2.1.8 Dress Code Policy

- Rumsan's objective in establishing a business casual dress code is to allow our employees to work comfortably in the workplace. Yet, we still need our employees and subcontractors to project a professional image. Business casual dress typically excludes shorts and clothing with images or text on them (except for professional logos).
- Good personal hygiene and personal habits are also very important. Body cleanliness, especially of the hands and fingernails, is a must.

2.2 Dealing with Media and Interviews

- The approval of the Chief Executive must be obtained before any written material is submitted to the media or any interview given.

2.3 Intoxicants and Controlled Substances

- It is the policy of the Company to maintain a workplace that is free from the effects of drug and alcohol abuse. Employees are prohibited from using, selling, distributing or possessing alcohol or illegal drugs in the work area at any time during the workday. In addition, employees are prohibited from the off-premises use of alcohol or possession, use or sale of illegal drugs, when such activities adversely affect job performance, job safety, or the Company's reputation in the community. Violators will be subject to immediate discipline, up to and including termination.

2.4 Data Handling Guidelines

At Rumsan, we are committed to protecting the privacy, confidentiality, and security of all personal and sensitive data entrusted to us. This section outlines the guidelines you must follow to ensure responsible data management in compliance with applicable data protection laws and regulations.

- Only access personal or sensitive data when it is necessary to perform your job responsibilities. Do not attempt to access data beyond your authorization level.
- If your work requires access to sensitive or personal data, you must sign a Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA) before gaining access. This NDA legally binds you to maintain confidentiality and avoid any misuse or unauthorized disclosure of the data.
- You must retain data only for as long as it is necessary to fulfill its intended purpose or as required by law. Once your task or project is complete, you are required to securely delete or return all data you accessed or received. After doing so, send a written confirmation to your manager confirming the deletion of the sensitive document.
- You must password-protect any files containing sensitive or confidential information before sharing them, whether online or offline. Do not store sensitive data on personal devices. Please refer to this guide on creating strong passwords.

- Immediately report any data breach, suspected misuse, or unauthorized access to the COO or your manager.

Failure to follow these data privacy responsibilities may lead to disciplinary action.

2.5 Smoking Policy

- We operate in a nonsmoking workplace. Smoking is prohibited at all times throughout the company's workplace. This includes, but is not limited to, private offices, restrooms and stairwells. Employees may smoke outside in designated areas during breaks.

3. BENEFITS

At Rumsan, we recognize that benefits are an essential part of your total compensation package. We strive to offer a range of benefits to ensure the well-being and satisfaction of our employees.

General Benefits for Full-Time Employees:

- Full-time employees are entitled to benefits such as insurance coverage, a Dashain bonus, appreciation days, internet packages, and other recreational services to support work-life balance and productivity.

Additional Benefits for Executives and Directors:

- Executives receive medical coverage of Rs. 2,00,000, while directors are provided Rs. 1,00,000 for personal, spouse, or children's medical expenses.
- Loans of Rs. 1,00,000 are available to executives and directors for purchasing EV scooters.

- An annual budget of Rs. 10,000 is allocated for health and well-being, and Rs. 15,000 is provided for skill and knowledge development.

Employee Referral Bonus:

- We encourage employees to help us find talented individuals to join our team. If a referred candidate is hired and successfully completes their probation period, the referring employee will receive a referral bonus of NRs. 10,000. This program not only rewards your efforts in strengthening our workforce but also supports our goal of building a team of top talent.

Rumsan values and supports its employees by offering these benefits to ensure a positive and enriching work environment.

3.1 Salary and Pay Periods

- Employees are paid monthly within fifteen (15) days of the commencement of the English calendar. The pay week begins on Monday and ends on Friday. Paychecks are normally distributed by your manager or transferred electronically to the bank accounts of the employees.
- No deductions will be made from your salary without your authorization, except for time lost through special leave, reimbursements, penalty, default, and accident or through absence at your request and with our consent.

3.2 Bonus and Other Payouts

- Employees are paid bonuses based on the performance review. Regular bonuses are paid to the employees based on the sales revenue and profit the company makes. Provisions of individual commissions on sales are available to the employees. Commissions and payouts are mentioned in the job contract if any.

3.3 Expense Reimbursement

- Where expenses have been incurred in the performance of your duties and provided that you have obtained your manager's approval to incur the expense, the company will reimburse you for all reasonable expenses incurred as part of undertaking your role.
- You should submit all valid PAN/VAT receipts in accordance with the expenses claimed. Please note that, where expenses are submitted to Rumsan Associates (P) Limited whenever possible, for repayment not claimed within that Fiscal Year after the expense is incurred, it may not be reimbursed.
- For a comprehensive and detailed explanation of this policy, please refer to the Rumsan Reimbursement Policy.

3.4 Travel Policy

- Any employee who requires traveling for business purpose must get approval in advance from the department head/ director and finance department along with approval mail to get the travel advance.
- Food expenses are allowed only as per the limit of entitlements except for alcoholic beverages or cigarettes etc. and food expenses are taken care of by the client in such cases only incidental expenses can be claimed.
- The expense report with travel requests submitted to the finance department must consist of the original boarding pass and travel -tickets, along with a complete tour report maintained date-wise. Any deviation from the tour program shall be approved by the business head/director as applicable.
- In case an employee wants to combine business stay with personal vacations, it must be duly approved by the director/HOD. It should be noted that no reimbursement would happen for any personal expense.

3.5 Holidays and leave

- The Company grants holiday time off to all full-time employees on the following holidays - 12 days of public holidays which will be decided by the management at the beginning of the English calendar and Ten (10) days of personal leave and Ten (10) sick days per year. Employees must get leave approved by their manager via email, including the manager, HR, and a closely working team member. HR will track leave records and notify if limits are exceeded. Only managers can approve leave, and unused personal and sick leave will expire at the end of the year. If a leave request is not approved but employees take a leave then unapproved leave is considered as unpaid leave.

3.5.1 Personal Leave

- Full-time employees are entitled to 10 personal leave days per calendar year.

- All personal leave requests must be approved by the employee's direct manager before taking leave. Employees should plan their leave in advance and communicate their requests in a timely manner.

- Unapproved leave will be considered unpaid leave, and salary deductions may apply accordingly.

- For single-day leave or short absences, employees must notify their manager at least 2 days in advance. Requests submitted with less notice may be denied based on work priorities.

- For leave of 2 or more consecutive days, employees must submit their request at least 1 week in advance. Approval is subject to business needs, work schedules, and team availability.

- HR will maintain records of all personal leave requests and usage to ensure proper tracking and compliance with company policies. Employees are responsible for adhering to the leave approval process to avoid disruptions in workflow.

3.5.2 Sick Leave

- All eligible full-time employees are entitled to Ten(10) sick days per year. Please notify your manager as soon as possible before your scheduled work time when you will not be reporting to work due to illness. Employees taking three consecutive days of sick leave must provide a doctor's prescription.

3.5.3 Bereavement Leave

- Eligible employees will receive up to 13 days with full pay in the event of the death of an immediate family member.
- Bereavement pay will be calculated as the base pay rate and will not include any special forms of compensation such as commissions. “Immediate family” is defined as the employee’s spouse, parent, child, sibling, father-in-law, mother-in-law, grandparent, grandchild, brother-in-law, or sister-in-law. This leave may be taken only twice during the entire employment tenure.

3.5.4 Time Off to Vote

- On days when elections for public office are scheduled, schedules will be changed as needed to ensure that the employee has an opportunity to vote.

3.5.5 Maternity Leave

- A female employee shall be granted a maternity leave of a total of fourteen (14) weeks before or after delivery where they compulsorily have to take leave from at least two (2) weeks before the expected due of delivery to at least six (6) weeks after the date of delivery. A female employee who takes maternity leave shall get full remuneration for sixty

(60) days and shall not get remuneration for the remaining period. Female employees are entitled to an additional month of unpaid leave, if she or a baby need further rest due to health conditions.

3.5.6 Paternity Leave

- Paternity leave shall be granted to a male employee during the birth of a baby for a period not exceeding fifteen (15) days including pre and post-natal and not more than twice during the entire period of service.

3.5.7 Swap Leave Policy

- Employees who work on designated holidays may swap that holiday for any other working day with prior approval. Swap leave must be pre-approved by the manager, and an email should be sent to HR for record tracking.
- Employees must maintain records of their swaps and submit them to HR for accurate tracking and payroll processing. Please use the following template to manage your Swap Leave.
- Written approval from the immediate manager is required, followed by a leave swap request to HR at least two days in advance.
- This leave must be used within 1 month of the worked holiday, or it will be rejected.

3.5.8 Leaves of Absence without Pay

- The Company provides leaves of absence without pay to full-time employees who wish to take off from work duties to fulfill personal obligations, or who are temporarily unable to work due to a medical reason.
- Requests for a leave of absence or any extension of an approved leave should be submitted through email to the employee's manager thirty (30) days before the commencement of the leave, or as soon as is practicable.

The final decision concerning the request will be made by the Company based on its business needs. All employees on approved leaves are expected to report any change of status in their need for leave or their intention to return to work to their manager.

- The Company will endeavor, but cannot guarantee, to reinstate an employee returning from a leave of absence to his or her same job or an equivalent position with equivalent status and pay. If an employee fails to return to work at the conclusion of an approved leave of absence, including any extension of the leave, the employee will be considered to have resigned.
- The company will approve an employee's leave request to take an exam, with a specified duration of absence under unpaid leave during that period.

4. LEAVING THE COMPANY

4.1 Resignation

- If you decide to leave for any reason, the company would like the opportunity to discuss the resignation beforehand to understand the reasons and see if there are any alternatives.
- However, if you still decide to leave the Company requests at least 30 days written resignation notice. If an employee does not provide advance notice as requested, the employee will be considered ineligible for re-hire.

4.2 Layoff

- If the Company decides to lay you off, you will be scheduled to meet with the company executive as soon as possible to discuss any severance, outplacement assistance, or other benefits that the Company may offer.

4.3 Discharge

- The Company may terminate an employee's employment, or an employee may terminate his/her employment, without cause, and with or without notice, at any time for any reason.
- Any employee whose conduct, actions or performance violates or conflicts with the Company's policies may be terminated immediately and without warning.

4.4 References

- Generally, the company does not provide employee/intern references but does provide a record of service - a factual record of service outlining the employee's name, job title, dates they were employed, and a brief outline of their role, signed by the Chief Executive.
- If a manager wishes to provide a personal comment they can do so but not in their capacity as a representative of the organization (or on the company letterhead). If you have any queries, please contact your manager.

EMPLOYEE ACKNOWLEDGEMENT FORM

I acknowledge that I have received a copy of Rumsan's Employee Handbook. I agree to read it thoroughly and seek clarification from management regarding any policy or provision that I do not understand.I hereby acknowledge that I have read and understood the Code of Conduct in its entirety and formally agree to comply with all the provisions and clauses contained therein.

Since the information, policies, and benefits described here are necessarily subject to change, I acknowledge that revisions to the handbook may occur. I understand that nothing contained in the Handbook may be construed as creating a promise of future benefits or a binding contract with the Company for benefits or

for any other purpose. I also understand that these policies and procedures are continually evaluated and may be amended, modified, or terminated at any time.

Please sign and date this receipt and return it to your manager.

_____ _____

Employee's Signature Date